

K-BALL

15-Ball Rotation — Standard Rules

House rules for Columbia Cue Club, structured in the style of the WPA Rules of Play.

WHAT IS K-BALL?

K-Ball is 15-ball rotation played to a target score. Fifteen numbered balls are racked and played in ascending numerical order. Every ball legally pocketed scores one point. The first player to reach the agreed target — 25 (recreational) or 50 (competitive) — wins the Match.

HOW K-BALL COMBINES 10-BALL AND 14.1

K-Ball borrows rotation order and standard fouls from WPA 10-Ball, and 1-point-per-ball, race-to-N scoring from WPA 14.1 Continuous Pool. Unlike 10-Ball, called shots are not required. Unlike 14.1, balls must be contacted in numerical order. All other WPA general rules apply unchanged.

HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

Every rule heading carries a source chip. Look for these:

[K-Ball] New K-Ball rule — bold italic heading. The reader's key differences.

[K-Ball · 10-Ball] Adapted from WPA 10-Ball with a K-Ball change — bold heading.

[K-Ball · 14.1] Adapted from WPA 14.1 Continuous with a K-Ball change — bold heading.

[10-Ball] Unchanged from WPA 10-Ball (cross-referenced, not reproduced).

[14.1] Unchanged from WPA 14.1 Continuous (cross-referenced, not reproduced).

[WPA General] Unchanged from WPA general rules or fouls (cross-referenced).

VERSION

K-Ball Rules v1.0

EFFECTIVE

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Scan: WPA Rules of Play (10-Ball, p. 24)

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1. GENERAL

1.1 APPLICABILITY OF THE WPA GENERAL RULES

All rules in WPA Section 1 (General Rules) apply to K-Ball unchanged. This includes WPA 1.1 Player's Responsibility, 1.2 Lagging to Determine First Break, 1.3 Subsequent Breaks, 1.4 Player's Use of Equipment, 1.5 Spotting Balls, 1.6 Cue-Ball in Hand, 1.8 Balls Settling, 1.9 Restoring a Position, 1.10 Outside Interference, 1.11 Prompting Calls and Protesting Rulings, 1.12 Concession, and 1.13 Stalemate. WPA 1.7 Standard Call Shot does NOT apply because K-Ball is not a call-shot Discipline (see K.5 below).

1.2 APPLICABILITY OF THE WPA FOULS

All fouls defined in WPA Section 3 (Fouls) apply to K-Ball as listed under K.9 (Standard Fouls) and K.10 (Serious Fouls). Any WPA foul not explicitly listed nevertheless remains in force where relevant to normal play.

1.3 GAME OVERVIEW

K-Ball is a rotation Discipline played with fifteen object-balls numbered 1 through 15 and the cue-ball. The object-balls are played in ascending numerical order. Each legally pocketed ball counts one point. The first player to reach the target score wins the Match. The standard targets are 25 points (recreational) and 50 points (competitive). Any other target may be agreed to before the Match and, when different from 25 or 50, must be noted on the score sheet.

WHAT'S NEW IN K-BALL

If you already know 10-Ball or 14.1, these are the K-Ball-specific rules to learn. Each one is marked [K-Ball] in the body of this document. All other rules are pointers into the current WPA Rules of Play.

K.2 The Rack [K-Ball]

The 1-ball on the Foot Spot at the apex, the 8-ball in the center of the triangle, the 15-ball and remaining balls placed randomly.

K.5 Shots Are Not Called [K-Ball]

Slop counts. Any legal contact with the lowest-numbered ball that results in a pocketed ball scores that ball, regardless of which pocket or combination produced it. A declared safety still passes the turn.

K.8 Scoring — 1 Point per Ball, Race to Target [K-Ball]

Each ball legally pocketed = 1 point. Each foul = -1 point. The Match ends the moment a player's SUBTOTAL reaches the target (25 or 50) on a legal shot; no single ball is the winning ball. Any additional balls pocketed in that winning rack may be recorded to a higher FINAL total for personal-best or high-score purposes, but do not affect who won or when.

K.6 No Special Spotting [K-Ball]

Unlike WPA 10-Ball, there is no rule that spots the highest ball when pocketed on a foul. Any ball pocketed on a foul or safety is spotted per WPA 1.5 like any other ball.

K.7 Continuing Play Across Racks [K-Ball]

When the 15-ball is legally pocketed, the balls are re-racked and the shooter continues with a new break under K.3. The Match does not end at rack boundaries — only when the target score is reached.

K. K-BALL (15-BALL ROTATION)

K-Ball is a rotation Discipline played with fifteen object-balls numbered 1 through 15 and the cue-ball. The object-balls must be contacted in ascending numerical order (rotation). Each ball legally pocketed counts one point, and the first player to reach the target score wins the Match. Called shots are not required.

K.2 THE RACK [K-Ball]

The fifteen object-balls are racked as tightly as possible in a triangular shape:

- (a) The 1-ball is at the apex of the triangle, on the Foot Spot.
- (b) The 8-ball is placed in the center of the triangle.
- (c) The 15-ball and the remaining object-balls are placed without purposeful or intentional pattern.

K.5 SHOTS ARE NOT CALLED [K-Ball]

K-Ball is NOT a call-shot Discipline. A ball is legally pocketed whenever the cue-ball first contacts the lowest-numbered ball remaining on the table and any object-ball is subsequently pocketed without a foul, regardless of which pocket, cushion route, or combination produced the pocketing. Slop counts. The shooter may, however, declare "safety" before any shot; if declared, play passes to the opponent at the end of the shot even if a ball is pocketed, and any pocketed object-ball is spotted per WPA 1.5.

K.6 SPOTTING BALLS [K-Ball]

Balls are spotted per WPA 1.5. K-Ball has no special provision for the highest-numbered ball; the 15-ball is treated like any other object-ball. If it is pocketed on a foul or on a declared safety, it is spotted per WPA 1.5.

K.7 CONTINUING PLAY [K-Ball]

If the shooter legally pockets at least one object-ball on a shot and does not foul, the shooter continues at the table. If the shooter misses, plays a safety, or fouls, play passes to the opponent. When the 15-ball is legally pocketed, all fifteen balls are re-racked (see K.2) and the player whose turn it is continues shooting, breaking the new rack under the requirements of K.3. The Match does not end at rack boundaries; it ends only when a player reaches the target score.

K.8 SCORING [K-Ball]

- (a) Each object-ball legally pocketed scores one point for the shooter.
- (b) Each foul subtracts one point from the offending player's score. Only one foul penalty is assessed per shot, even when multiple infractions occur (per WPA 3).
- (c) The Match ends the moment a player's SUBTOTAL first reaches the agreed target score on a legal shot. Any legal ball may be the winning ball; there is no dedicated "money ball" (contrast WPA 10-Ball, where only the 10-ball wins).
- (d) Once a player has reached the target, any additional balls pocketed in that same winning rack may be recorded to a higher FINAL total for personal-best or house high-score purposes. This does not change who won, nor when the Match ended; the record is simply a courtesy for the winning player. Recording extra balls is optional; if either player prefers, play stops at the target.
- (e) The standard targets are 25 points (recreational) and 50 points (competitive). Any other target may be agreed to before the Match starts and must be noted on the score sheet.

K.3 LEGAL BREAK SHOT [K-Ball · 10-Ball]

- (a) The cue-ball begins in hand above the Head String (see WPA 1.6 Cue-Ball in Hand and WPA 3.10 Bad Cue-Ball Placement).
- (b) The first object-ball contacted by the cue-ball must be the 1-ball.
- (c) If no object-ball is pocketed, at least four object-balls must be driven to one or more rails, or the shot is a foul (see K.9).
- (d) Pocketing the 1-ball on the break scores one point for the breaker and continues the inning. Pocketing any other ball on a legal break also scores one point per ball and continues the inning.

K.1 DETERMINING THE BREAK [K-Ball · 10-Ball]

Players lag as described in WPA 1.2 (Lagging to Determine First Break). The player who wins the lag chooses who will break the first Rack. Subsequent breaks alternate between players (WPA 1.3).

K.4 SECOND SHOT OF THE RACK — PUSH OUT [K-Ball · 10-Ball]

If no foul is committed on the break shot, the shooter may choose to play a “push out.” The player must inform the referee (or, in unofficiated play, the opponent) before the shot; then WPA 3.2 (Wrong Ball First) and WPA 3.3 (No Rail after Contact) are suspended for that shot. Balls pocketed on a push out do NOT score and are spotted per WPA 1.5. If no foul is committed on the push out, the other player chooses who will shoot next.

K.9 STANDARD FOULS [WPA General]

If the shooter commits a standard foul, one point is subtracted from his score, and play passes to the opponent. The cue-ball is in hand for the incoming player, who may place it anywhere on the playing surface (see WPA 1.6). The following standard fouls apply at K-Ball; refer to the WPA Rules of Play for the definitive text:

- WPA 3.1 Cue-Ball Scratch or Off the Table.
- WPA 3.2 Wrong Ball First — the first object-ball contacted by the cue-ball on each shot must be the lowest-numbered ball remaining on the table.
- WPA 3.3 No Rail after Contact.
- WPA 3.4 No Foot on Floor.
- WPA 3.5 Ball Driven Off the Table — all such balls are spotted.
- WPA 3.6 Touched Ball.
- WPA 3.7 Double Hit / Frozen Balls.
- WPA 3.8 Push Shot.
- WPA 3.9 Balls Still Moving.
- WPA 3.10 Bad Cue-Ball Placement.
- WPA 3.12 Playing Out of Turn.
- WPA 3.14 Slow Play.
- WPA 3.15 Ball Rack Template Foul.

K.10 SERIOUS FOULS [WPA General]

For WPA 3.13 (Three Consecutive Fouls), the penalty is loss of the current Rack: all balls in the current rack are re-racked, the offending player's consecutive-foul count is reset, and the offending player must break under K.3. For WPA 3.16 (Unsportsmanlike Conduct), the referee — or, in unofficiated play, mutual agreement of the players — will choose a penalty appropriate to the offense, up to and including forfeiture of the Match.

K.11 STALEMATE [WPA General]

If a stalemate occurs as described in WPA 1.13, the original breaker of the current Rack breaks again under K.3. Points scored prior to the stalemate remain in effect.

APPENDIX A — COMPARISON WITH 10-BALL AND 14.1

The table below summarises how K-Ball relates to the two WPA disciplines it borrows from. K-Ball adopts rotation and standard fouls from 10-Ball, and 1-point-per-ball / race-to-target scoring from 14.1. It differs from both parents in that shots are NOT called (see K.5) and no single ball is a “winning ball” (see K.8).

	K-Ball	10-Ball (WPA 6)	14.1 (WPA 7)
Object-balls	1 through 15	1 through 10	1 through 15
Play order	Rotation (lowest)	Rotation (lowest)	Any legal ball
Call shots?	No	Yes	Yes
Scoring	1 pt per ball	Winning-ball only	1 pt per ball
Win condition	First to reach target	Legally pocket 10	First to reach target
Foul penalty	–1 point, BIH	BIH (rack-based)	–1 point, BIH-above
Race target	25 or 50	N/A (rack-based)	Match-dependent
Re-rack when	15 pocketed	After each rack	14 pocketed (keep 15th)
Rack apex	1-ball, 8 in center	1-ball, 10 in center	Apex ball (varies)

APPENDIX B — WORKED SCORING EXAMPLES

The examples below illustrate how points and fouls combine over a series of racks. Each example assumes a race to 25.

B.1 Simple run of three racks [K-Ball]

- Rack 1: Player A legally pockets 8 balls, then misses. RACK TOTAL = 8. Player B pockets the remaining 7. Rack 1 GAME SUBTOTAL: A = 8, B = 7.
- Rack 2: A pockets 10 balls (including one bank shot — slop counts), then commits a scratch foul on the 12-ball. RACK TOTAL = 10 – 1 = 9. B pockets the remaining 5. Rack 2 SUBTOTAL: A = 8 + 9 = 17, B = 7 + 5 = 12.
- Rack 3: B breaks and pockets 13 balls in a row. B's SUBTOTAL hits 25 on the ball that took B from 24 to 25 — B wins the Match at that instant. B chooses to continue and pocket the last 2 balls of the rack for a FINAL total of 27, recorded as high score. A's FINAL = 17.

B.2 Foul penalty near a low score [K-Ball]

A score may go negative from foul penalties (per WPA 14.1 tradition). If a player is at 0 and commits a foul, that player's SUBTOTAL becomes –1. Recording is straightforward on the score sheet: enter the negative RACK TOTAL and carry it forward to the next SUBTOTAL cell.

APPENDIX C — WPA CROSS-REFERENCE INDEX

Every WPA rule cited in this document is listed below with its WPA section number. Scan the QR on the cover (or visit wpapool.com/rules/) to open the current WPA Rules of Play PDF, where these sections appear verbatim.

WPA §	Rule	Used in K-Ball as
WPA 1.2	Lagging to Determine First Break	cited in K.1
WPA 1.3	Subsequent Breaks	cited in K.1
WPA 1.5	Spotting Balls	cited in K.4, K.6
WPA 1.6	Cue-Ball in Hand	cited in K.3, K.9
WPA 1.7	Standard Call Shot	NOT applied (see K.5)
WPA 1.13	Stalemate	cited in K.11
WPA 3.1	Cue-Ball Scratch or Off the Table	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.2	Wrong Ball First	standard foul (lowest ball first)
WPA 3.3	No Rail after Contact	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.4	No Foot on Floor	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.5	Ball Driven Off the Table	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.6	Touched Ball	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.7	Double Hit / Frozen Balls	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.8	Push Shot	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.9	Balls Still Moving	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.10	Bad Cue-Ball Placement	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.12	Playing Out of Turn	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.13	Three Consecutive Fouls	serious foul at K-Ball (K.10)
WPA 3.14	Slow Play	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.15	Ball Rack Template Foul	standard foul at K-Ball
WPA 3.16	Unsportsmanlike Conduct	serious foul at K-Ball (K.10)